

What is democracy? Why Democracy?

→ Democracy → Greek Word

Demos → People
Kratos - Rule

→ Rule by the people

• Democracy originated in Greek city state called Athens in 5th Century.

* Democracy is a protest against Monarchy.

* ⇒ Definitions of Democracy:

- 1) Democracy is a Road to Socialism - (Karl Marx)
- 2) Govt. in which weaker has the equal opportunity as that of a Richer. → (Gandhi Ji).
- 3) Govt. of the people, for the people and by the people. - (Abraham Lincoln).
- 4) Thomas Jefferson - U.S President → (1801-1809)



Democracy is the Govt. where the will of the majority Prevails."

⇒ Features of the Democracy:

- 1) Decisions are taken by the majority.
- 2) Free, fair and Transparent elections.
- 3) Periodic and regular elections.
- 4) Efficient electoral Competition.
- 5) One Person, One Vote and One Value.
- 6) Rule of law and respect for the rights.
- 7) Inclusion of the marginalised groups in the decision making process.
- 8) Accommodation of the differences by peaceful means.



9) Provision of the opposition to the govt.

⇒ Arguments in Favour of Democracy:

- 1) A Democratic govt. more Accountable Answerable and Responsible.
- 2) Democratic govt. improves the quality of the decision making by ~~due~~ decisions, debates and consultations.
- 3) Democracy provides methods to settle disputes and conflicts by Negotiations, Mediations, lending good offices, etc.
- 4) Democracy enhances the dignity of the citizens through equality.
- 5) Democracy allows us to correct our mistakes.



by discussions and changing rulers.

- 6) ~~Multilateral~~ Multilateral decision making by involving all the sections of the society in the decision making process.

⇒ Arguments Against Democracy:

- 1) Political Instability due to changing rulers or leaders.
- 2) Delayed decision making due to the consultation.
- 3) Electoral competition leads to conflicts and Immorality.
- 1) Elections drain the country financially.
- 1) Elected persons do not know the best interests of the people.

Date ____ / ____ / ____



6) Factionalism in the Pol. Parties.

7) Corruption in the election.



- Constitution: Derived from the latin Word Constitutio
Constitutions. (Arrangement or Organisation).

• The constitution is a body or set of laws according to which the people are governed.

→ South Africa:

- An African Country.
 - Blacks are in Majority $\approx 78\%$.
 - Ruled by the minority community of Whites.
 - Blacks were discriminated by the Whites due to their ~~black~~ black skin colour.
- Considered as inferior to whites.

This discrimination of the blacks by the Whites



on the basis of the skin color is called Racial discrimination.

- Blacks were prejudiced.
- This racial discrimination of the blacks by whites is called as Apartheid.
- It was a legal process.
- Blacks were not allowed to use the public utilities like Restaurants, Parks, Beaches, buses, churches, etc, by the Whites.
- Blacks had separate schools, hospitals, ambulances
- This practice of separating or excluding the blacks from the Whites in South Africa in every domain is called as Racial Segregation.



- This was legalised by Whites Govt.
- Though legal but an Inhuman practice.
- In 1912: African National Congress :- ANC founder
- It launched the anti-Apartheid movement in South Africa.
- ANC was joined by Nelson Mandela.
- Nelson Mandela campaigned against the Apartheid.
- Born in 1918
- Died in 2013
- In 1964 → Mandela was arrested along with his seven colleagues.

They all were imprisoned in the most deadly prison of South Africa called Robben Islands.

He continued his anti-Apartheid movement



from jail as well.

- Finally he was released in 1992 (28 years)
- In 1993 → Presidential elections of south Africa were held.
- Nelson Mandela was awarded with Bharat Ratna Award in 1990.
- Noble peace prize in 1993
- Awarded with a ~~doct~~ doctorate degree by South Australian University in 1998.